tions of modern life—and it seems that at last this hoary and

tenacious relic of past times must die.

But while we struggle with caste in India (which, in its origin,

**Gandhiji's references to caste have been progressively stronger and more pointed, and he*

*has made it repeatedly clear that caste as a whole and as it exists must be eliminated. Referring to the constructive programme which he has placed before the nation, he says: '/( has*

*undoubtedly independence, political, social and economic, as its aim. It is a moral, non-violent revolution in all the departments of life of a big nation, at the end of which caste and untouchability and such other superstitions must vanish, differences between Hindu ahd Muslim become things of the past, enmity against Englishmen or Europeans must be wholly forgotten*

*And again quite recently: 'The caste system, as we know, is an anachronism. It must go if*

*both Hinduism and India are to live and grow from day to day.'*

27

was based on colour), new and overbearing castes have arisen in

the west with doctrines of racial exclusiveness, sometimes cloth-

ed in political and economic terms, and even speaking in the

language of democracy.

Before the Buddha, seven hundred years before Christ, a great

Indian, the sage and lawgiver Yagnavalkya, is reported to have

said: 'It is not our religion, still less the colour of our skin, that